In reality, after the June violence the state refused to help those who had suffered or to investigate allegations of security forces' involvement.[20] Instead, President Thein Sein called for Rohingyas, once again described as 'illegal' non-citizens, to be transferred to other countries.[21] This statement effectively called for the forced deportation of an entire community. This demand has been repeated ever since and is now a regular part of the rhetoric of the extremists. As we will see, the desire to push the Rohingyas out of Myanmar has been one cause of the 2015 refugee crisis. The goal of expulsion is shared by most Rakhine community leaders and this pattern of blaming the Rohingyas for their own persecution has become the standard response of the Myanmar authorities.

By the end of June the first wave of spontaneous violence died down. In the meantime President Sein established a committee to investigate the June events and 'find solutions for communities with different religious groups to live together in harmony'.[22] In a speech at the end of August he suggested that the Rakhine bore responsibility for the June violence, stating that 'political parties, some monks, and some individuals are increasing the ethnic hatred'.[23] However, when his commission finally reported in July 2013 it blamed the Rohingyas for harming the good name of Myanmar with the international community[24] and said nothing about state complicity in the violence.

Unfortunately, the June events turned out to be simply a prelude to a larger wave of attacks in October. After the first wave of violence, Buddhist monks circulated pamphlets demanding that ethnic Rakhine cease all economic ties with the Rohingyas, ordering them not to sell them goods or associate with them. The pamphlets claimed that the Rohingyas were planning the 'extinction of the Arakanese'[25] as they were 'stealing our land, drinking our water, and killing our people. They are eating our rice and staying near our houses. So we will separate. We don't want any connection to the Muslim people at all'.[26] This campaign was widespread, seeking to isolate the Rohingyas economically and socially while at the same time claiming they represented a mortal threat to the Rakhine. In effect, there were twin demands that the Rohingyas go 'home' (that is, to Bangladesh) and that, if they stayed, they should be isolated within Rakhine province. One monk told the BBC that 'around the world there are many Muslim